

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ K 9 4 3

♥ 8 5

♦ 10 8 5 3 2

♣ 7 6

♠ A J

♥ A Q 10 9 4 3

♦ J

♣ A J 9 4



♠ Q 10 8 5 2

♥ 6

♦ Q 9 7

♣ K Q 5 2

♠ 7 6

♥ K J 7 2

♦ A K 6 4

♣ 10 8 3

West

North

East

South

1 ♥

Pass

3 ♥

Pass

6 ♥

All Pass

6 ♥ by North

♥10 to dummy's ♥K, pulling the last trump as you enter dummy.

After hearing a limit raise, North's leap to 6 ♥ is, well, bold let's say. North plays 6 ♥. East leads the ♠5, West plays the ♠K.

Very bold in fact. The opening lead has exposed a ♠ loser in addition to your two ♣ losers. On the plus side dummy has an extra ♦ trick. You are going to have to try to throw East in with the ♣ suit, but you will have to be very careful with dummy's entries.

Win the ♠A, play the ♦J to dummy's ♦K and discard the ♠J on dummy's ♦A.

You are in dummy, so ruff the ♠7 with a high trump. Next play the ♥9 to dummy's ♥J. Both defenders follow, whew!

Back in dummy, ruff a ♦ with the ♥Q, then lead the

It would be great if you could ruff dummy's last ♦, then get back to dummy with a trump so you could lead a ♣ from dummy and finesse. But check your trumps. If you do that you will have no more trumps in your hand and East won't be endplayed because you have no ruff-sluff. The only thing you can do is to go ahead and play ♣s now, finessing into East and HOPING he has no more ♦s!

You were lucky, East had only three ♦s so your partial elimination worked.

But if it had turned out that East DID have another ♦, and led it, all would not be lost. You would ruff in your hand, play a trump to dummy, then take a second ♣ finesse. If it turned out the ♣K and ♣Q were in different hands you would make the slam.

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K J 10 8 6 5 3	♠ A 7 2	♠ -
♥ 10 5	♥ K Q J	♥ 8 7 4 3 2
♦ J 10 8	♦ 7 5 2	♦ 9 6 4 3
♣ 3	♣ K J 6 2	♣ 10 9 8 7
	N W E S	
	♠ Q 9 4	
	♥ A 9 6	
	♦ A K Q	
	♣ A Q 5 4	

West	North	East	South
3♠	6NT		2NT
All Pass			
6NT by South follow.			

Some bidding, huh? Well, what would you have bid in the North seat? South plays 6NT. West leads the ♦ J.

Mirror distributions! So you can only make ten tricks in ♥s, ♦s and ♣s.

That means you will have to make two ♠ tricks. And since the odds are 5000 to 1 that West has the ♠ K, leading toward your ♠ Q is NOT your play.

Win the ♦ and play 4 rounds of ♣s. West follows to the first, then discards 3 ♠s.

Next play 3 ♥ winners. West follows twice, then discards a ♠.

Now play your 2 ♦ winners. East and West both

[showcards N:SA,S7,S2 S:SQ,S9,S4]

Keeping your fingers crossed that West must win the next trick you play the ♠ 9. West puts on the ♠ 10, you play low in dummy, and East (thankfully) discards a ♥.

[showcards N:SA,S7 S:SQ,S4]

West has been thrown in and he has nothing left but the ♠ K J. Whichever one he plays you will take the last two tricks.

West no doubt thought his 3♠ bid was a good idea.

In fact, it just kept you from making a losing play, (leading toward the ♠ Q), and allowed you to find the end-play to make the slam.